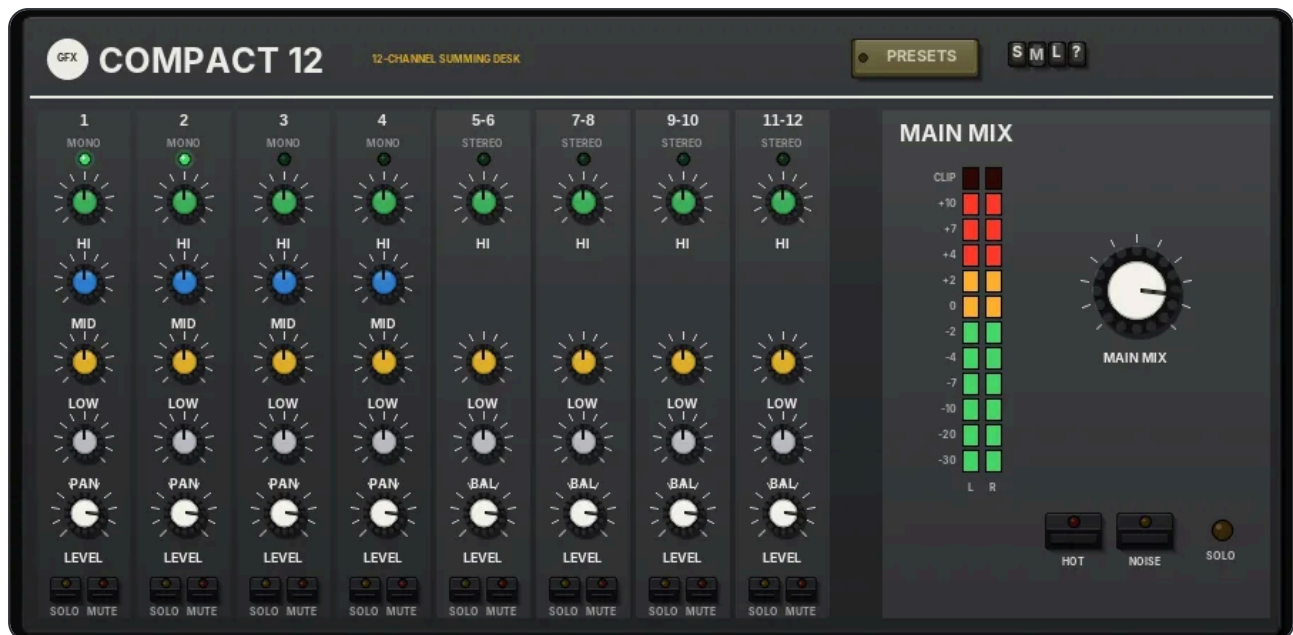


Compact 12

The little 12-channel desk from every 90s project studio, as a summing mixer.



Overview

Compact 12 is a summing mixer in the spirit of the famous compact low-noise desks of the 90s: four mono channels and four stereo pairs, each with EQ, pan or balance, level, solo and mute, summed to a stereo main mix.

It is clean and honest, with the tight, slightly forward sound of its op-amps. Switch HOT on and the summing amps are driven into their rails for grit, edge and a little bite (level-matched, so it does not just get louder). NOISE adds the desk's own hiss floor.

Each channel strip can be named, and the names are saved with the project.

Reach for it for

- Summing stems or groups through a simple desk
- Quick level, pan and tone balancing of up to 12 inputs in one place
- Adding op-amp edge to a mix or drum bus (HOT)
- Lo-fi, 'real desk' character with the noise floor
- Solo and mute of stems while mixing

Setting up the routing in REAPER

1. Create a bus track and put Compact 12 on it. Open the track's ROUTE window and set Track channels to 12.
2. For the mono channels, add a send from each mono source to the bus track and set its destination to a single channel: channel 1, 2, 3 or 4.
3. For the stereo channels, send each stereo stem to a channel pair: 5/6, 7/8, 9/10 or 11/12.
4. Turn off the master send on every source track, so it is heard only through Compact 12 (otherwise you hear it twice).
5. The mix leaves on channels 1/2, so leave the bus track's master send on. The green light at the top of each strip lights when signal arrives on it.

Controls

The header

PRESETS	Opens the list of factory presets (a click on the preset display does the same). The presets set the master section or flatten the channels; the last entry resets everything to the defaults.
◀ / ▶	Step to the previous or next preset. The display shows the number and name of the preset in use.
S / M / L	Panel size: small, medium or large. The panel also scales to fit the plugin window.
?	Opens a pop-up with the design credit, the GFX website address and the address of this manual. Click anywhere to close it.

Channel strips

Eight strips: CH 1 to 4 are MONO, CH 5-6, 7-8, 9-10 and 11-12 are STEREO. Knobs: drag up and down (Shift for fine control) or use the mouse wheel; double-click to reset. The value shows while you hover.



Name	Click the name at the top of a strip and type (e.g. Drums). Enter keeps it, Escape cancels; an empty name goes back to the channel number.
Signal light	The green light glows when audio arrives on that channel and the channel is being heard (not muted, turned off or left out by a solo).
HI (green cap)	High shelf at 12 kHz, -15 to +15 dB.
MID (blue cap)	Mono channels only: a bell at 2.5 kHz, -12 to +12 dB.
LOW (yellow cap)	Low shelf at 80 Hz, -15 to +15 dB.
PAN / BAL	Mono channels: PAN, a constant-power pan from L100 to R100. Stereo channels: BAL, which turns the other side down as you move away from the centre.
LEVEL	The channel's level, from OFF (fully left, -60 dB) to +10 dB; 0 dB by default.
SOLO	Solo in place. Any number of channels can be soloed at once; while anything is soloed, only the soloed channels are heard.
MUTE	Silences the channel. A muted channel stays muted even when it is soloed.

MAIN MIX

Meters	12-LED meters for the main mix, left and right. 0 is 0 VU (-18 dBFS); the top light is CLIP.
MAIN MIX	The main mix level into the summing amps, from OFF (-60 dB) to +10 dB.
HOT	Drives the summing amps into their rails: asymmetric op-amp grit, edge and a little bite, level-matched. Off, the amps stay clean up to just above 0 dBFS.
NOISE	Adds the desk's own hiss floor, about -84 dBFS.

SOLO

Flashes while any channel is soloed.

There is no separate output stage on this unit: its own character does that job.

Presets

The first four presets set only MAIN MIX, HOT and NOISE; the channel settings are left alone.

Clean Desk	MAIN MIX at 0 dB, HOT and NOISE off.
Hot Desk	HOT on: the summing amps driven into their rails.
Hot and Noisy	HOT and NOISE both on - the real thing.
Clean with Desk Noise	Clean amps with the hiss floor, MAIN MIX at -3 dB.
Flat all channels	Every channel back to 0 dB level, flat EQ, centred, with solos and mutes off. The master section and channel names are left alone.
Reset all to defaults	Every control back to its starting value.

Tips

- Name the strips as soon as the routing is done; it makes solo and mute much quicker to use.
- HOT is level-matched, so you can switch it in and out to judge the colour fairly.
- Use the MID on mono channels at 2.5 kHz to bring a vocal or guitar forward, or cut it to push them back.
- Keep the main-mix meters around 0 (0 VU) and below the red: that is where the desk sounds as intended.
- BAL on a stereo stem keeps both sides of the stem; to narrow it, do that on the stem's own track.

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